

Technical and rights questions for Microsoft review

Prepared: July 13, 2026

Prepared by: Shuhan He

Status: Prepared for discussion. Any Microsoft participation would require Microsoft's approval.

Proposal selection

The current filing plan is **CT Scan** and **Blood Bag**, with **Pill Box** as the first alternate. I would value Microsoft's view on whether these are the right concepts to prioritize before the July 31 deadline.

- Does each concept add a clear meaning that existing emoji cannot express well?
- Should Pill Box remain the medication option, or does the existing Pill emoji make it unnecessary?
- Is Blood Bag sufficiently distinct from Drop of Blood and IV Bag?
- Does CT Scan remain recognizable as a scanner and procedure rather than X-Ray, MRI, or a generic machine?

Emoji design and accessibility

- Can an unfamiliar viewer identify each image at 18 and 72 pixels?
- Does the essential silhouette survive in true black and white?
- Does the image depend on text, numbers, labels, a protected symbol, or familiar product design?
- Would the concept translate clearly into Segoe UI Emoji while remaining distinct from protected product designs?
- Are there clinical details that could mislead a patient or make the image too narrow?

Microsoft would create its own glyph if Unicode encoded the character. The attached images are examples used to test recognizability.

Evidence and Unicode process

- Do the refreshed Search, Video, Web Trends, Image Trends, and Books exhibits follow Unicode's current query method?
- Does the proposal distinguish public usage evidence from medical importance or professional support?
- Are the inclusion and exclusion factors answered using Unicode's current labels and meanings?
- After the individual submissions are received, would Microsoft's Unicode representatives be willing to ask ESR to consider adding them to an upcoming agenda as part of its normal review process?
- Would Microsoft's standards team review the separate health-coverage discussion draft and, if it agrees that the question merits UTC discussion, help revise it for submission?

Artwork rights and public references

- Does the final record identify the artwork creator and show that Shuhan He owns the submitted image or has a sufficient assignment and license?
- Is the public-domain or CC0 statement consistent with the underlying ownership record?
- Are all third-party screenshots clearly presented as evidence rather than original artwork?
- Is any Microsoft name, employee, product, or anticipated implementation statement included only after the responsible owner approves the exact wording?

The public proposal will identify Shuhan He as the submitter. Microsoft and individual employees would be named only with their express approval.

Two possible Microsoft actions

Individual proposals. After submission through the official form, Microsoft's standards representatives could ask ESR to consider adding the proposals to an upcoming agenda as part of its normal review process. Unicode controls the agenda, review, and outcome.

Technical discussion document. Microsoft's standards team could submit a revised document, coauthor one with Shuhan He, or use the draft as source material for its own document. If Unicode accepts a document into the public register, Unicode would assign the L2 number. Each emoji candidate would continue through the separate Emoji Submission Form.

Public sources

Unicode emoji proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>

Unicode document-submission process:

<https://www.unicode.org/pending/docsubmit.html>

Apple accessibility proposal, L2/18-080:

<https://www.unicode.org/L2/L2018/18080-accessibility-emoji.pdf>